



MONEY YOU'RE OWED

Bank & Card Fee Reversal Scripts

CLAIM WHAT'S RIGHTFULLY YOURS

The official process is always free. This kit doesn't sell you secrets — it's the done-for-you implementation: fill-in letters, word-for-word scripts, and trackers that save you the hours. Every method is built on official 2026 U.S. rules (DOT, IRS, CFPB, FDIC, state programs).

Bank & Card Fee Reversal Scripts

Money You're Owed — *Get back what's yours, the honest way.*

The promise: Word-for-word scripts that turn a 5-minute phone call or chat into a refunded fee — without begging, bluffing, or paying anyone.

This is implementation, not a secret. The "what" is already free — our videos and free guides teach it, and every bank's process is free to use. What you're paying \$12 for is the **done-for-you "how"**: the exact words to say, the order to say them in, and what to do when they say no. You are never paying for a right, and you never need to.

Read this first (the honest framing)

Fee reversals are **goodwill** decisions in almost every case below. There is no federal law that *forces* a bank to refund an overdraft, late, maintenance, ATM, or foreign-transaction fee. A representative grants the reversal because:

1. You're a customer they'd rather keep than lose, **and**
2. You gave them an easy, polite reason to say yes.

That's it. These scripts work because they make the "yes" the path of least resistance for the person on the line. They are not legal threats, and you should not deliver them as threats.

What realistic success looks like:

- **First-time fee, good standing, polite ask:** very often reversed. This is the bank's "courtesy/goodwill" reversal and most reps can do it without a manager.
- **Second or third request in a year:** harder. Many banks track "courtesy reversals" and cap them (commonly one or two per 12 months). Be honest with yourself about where you are.
- **You genuinely caused it and have a thin history:** lowest odds. Still worth one calm ask — but don't escalate or invent a hardship that isn't real.

The one rule that beats every script: be calm, be brief, ask once clearly, then stop talking. Silence does more work than arguing.

What's in this pack

#	Asset	Use it when...
00	This intro + how-to-use	Start here
01	Magic Words Quick Card	Print it. Keep it by the phone. One page.
02	Overdraft / NSF fee reversal (phone + chat)	An overdraft or returned/insufficient-funds fee hit your account
03	Late-payment fee waiver (phone + chat)	A credit card or loan late fee posted
04	Monthly maintenance fee waiver (phone + chat)	A monthly checking/savings service fee posted
05	Returned-item fee reversal (phone + chat)	A deposited check or ACH bounced and you were charged
06	ATM fee reversal (phone + chat)	An out-of-network or operator ATM surcharge hit you
07	Foreign-transaction fee reversal (phone + chat)	A 1–3% FX fee posted on a card purchase or abroad

#	Asset	Use it when...
08	Credit-card annual-fee: retention + product-change call	Your annual fee just posted and you want it waived, offset, or downgraded
09	Reg E overdraft opt-OUT request (phone + chat + written)	You want to STOP overdraft "coverage" on debit/ATM so future fees can't happen
10	Reversal Log (how to use) + reversal - log . csv	Track every call so you never lose a refund or repeat a mistake; import the CSV into Sheets/Excel as the tracker itself

How to use these scripts

- 1. Pick your channel.** Phone usually wins for anything discretionary — a human can override more than a chatbot, and tone carries. Use chat when you hate phones, when you want a written record, or when phone hold times are brutal. Both versions are below for every fee.
- 2. Fill the [BRACKETS] before you start.** Anything in [SQUARE BRACKETS] is yours to fill — name, dates, amounts, the fee description exactly as it appears on your statement. Have your statement open.
- 3. Follow the branches.** Each script has a ► **If they say YES** and ► **If they say NO / "I can't"** path. Don't improvise — the branches are the whole point.
- 4. Use the "magic words," then stop.** The single most effective line in this entire pack is:

"Would you be willing to reverse this as a one-time courtesy?"

Say it. Then go quiet and let them work.

- 5. Log it (file 10).** Date, who you spoke to, reference number, outcome. This protects you if a promised refund doesn't post, and tells you next time whether you've already used your "courtesy" for the year.

Ground rules (the brand promise)

- **The official process is always free.** Every bank lets you ask for a reversal at no cost. Never pay a third party to "recover" a fee for you.
- **Don't lie.** Don't invent a hardship, a death, or a "your system error" that didn't happen. A real reason stated plainly beats a fake one every time, and dishonesty can cost you the relationship.
- **Reversal is discretionary.** Nothing here guarantees a refund. We've written each script to maximize the odds honestly — that's all anyone can do.
- **One exception — your actual rights (file 09):** Whether your bank may charge overdraft fees on everyday **debit-card and ATM** transactions is *not* discretionary. Under federal law you must have opted **in** for those, and you can opt **out** anytime. That script asserts a right; the rest ask a favor. Know the difference.

A note on the law (current as of 2026)

These are negotiation scripts, not legal demands, so they lean on courtesy — not statutes. But the context matters, and the law changed recently, so here's the honest picture:

- **There is no federal cap on overdraft fees.** A 2024 CFPB rule that would have capped certain large-bank overdraft fees at \$5 was **repealed by Congress in May 2025** (Congressional Review Act, S.J. Res. 18 / Pub. L. 119-10, signed

May 9, 2025) and never took effect. Anyone telling you "the law caps your overdraft at \$5" is wrong. Fees are set by your bank.

- **There is no \$8 cap on credit-card late fees.** A 2024 CFPB rule that would have set an \$8 safe-harbor late fee was **vacated by a federal court on April 15, 2025** (N.D. Tex., *Chamber of Commerce v. CFPB*, No. 4:24-cv-00213-P). The older CARD Act "safe harbor" amounts (roughly \$30 for a first late payment and ~\$41 for a repeat, adjusted for inflation) remain the framework. Your late fee is whatever your cardholder agreement says, within that range.
- **Reg E overdraft opt-in is real and in force** (12 CFR 1005.17). Your bank cannot charge you overdraft fees on ATM or one-time debit-card transactions unless you affirmatively opted in — and you can revoke that opt-in at any time. That's the basis for file 09.
- **Unauthorized or erroneous transactions are a different process** (Reg E error resolution, 12 CFR 1005.11; liability limits, 12 CFR 1005.6). If a charge or fee is *wrong* — not just unwanted — you dispute it, you don't ask for a courtesy. We flag where that applies.

We'll never tell you a courtesy is a right. The two we *do* call rights — opting out (file 09) and disputing genuine errors — are the only two that are.

Money You're Owed — practical tools to claim what's yours. The official process is always free; this pack just does the work for you.

The "Magic Words" Quick Card

When/how to use this: Print this one page and keep it by the phone. It's the whole pack distilled into the lines that actually move a rep to "yes." If you only read one page, read this one.

What law backs it: Nothing — and that's the point. Fee reversals are a *courtesy*, not a right, so these are persuasion lines, not legal claims. (The one exception is opting out of debit/ATM overdraft coverage, which *is* a right — see file 09.)

The single most powerful line

"Would you be willing to reverse this as a one-time courtesy?"

Say it once. Then **stop talking** and let them work. Silence closes more reversals than arguing ever will.

The 4-beat structure (every call, every chat)

1. **Be warm + name the relationship.** *"Hi — I've banked with you for [X] years and I'm hoping you can help me with something small."*
2. **State the fee plainly, no story.** *"I was charged a [\$ amount] [fee name] on [date]."*
3. **Ask with the magic words.** *"Would you be willing to reverse it as a one-time courtesy?"*
4. **Go quiet.** Let them say yes.

Phrases that help

- "I take responsibility for this — I'm just asking for a one-time courtesy."
- "I'd really like to keep my account here in good standing."
- "I've been a customer since [year]."
- "Is there anything you can do on your end today?"
- "I completely understand it's at your discretion — I'm just asking."

Phrases to avoid

- ❌ "This is illegal." (It isn't — and it ends the goodwill.)
- ❌ "I'll close my account!" (Empty threats burn the rep's willingness. Only say it if it's true and you mean it.)
- ❌ Long backstory. Reps reverse fees faster when the ask is short.
- ❌ Anything you have to lie to say.

If they say YES

- "Thank you — I really appreciate it."
- **Get it in writing:** "Can you give me a reference number for this?"
- **Confirm timing:** "When will the credit post?"
- **Log it** (file 10): date, name, reference #, amount, post date.

If they say NO / "I can't"

1. **Ask once more, softly:** *"I understand. Is there a supervisor or a retention team who might be able to as a courtesy?"*

2. **Try the other channel:** if phone said no, try chat tomorrow (or vice versa) — a different rep is a different answer.
 3. **Switch to prevention:** *"Understood. Can you tell me how to avoid this fee going forward?"* (e.g., opt out of overdraft — file 09; set up alerts; waive maintenance with direct deposit — file 04.)
 4. **Know when to stop.** If you've genuinely used your courtesy for the year, accept it gracefully. Burning the relationship costs more than the fee.
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The mindset

You are not begging and you are not entitled. You're a customer making a reasonable, polite request that costs the bank almost nothing to grant. Calm + brief + one clear ask = your best odds.

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Overdraft / NSF Fee Reversal — Phone + Chat Scripts

When/how to use this: Use after an **overdraft fee** (the bank paid a transaction that put you negative and charged you) or an **NSF / returned-item fee** (the bank declined it and still charged you) posts to your checking account. Best within a few days of the fee, while it's fresh and you're still in good standing. Have your statement open with the exact fee amount and date.

What law backs it: No law forces this reversal — it's a goodwill courtesy. There is **no federal cap on overdraft fees** (the 2024 CFPB \$5-cap rule was repealed by Congress in 2025, Pub. L. 119-10). If the fee came from a **debit-card or ATM** overdraft and you never opted in, that's different — that may be an improper charge under Reg E (12 CFR 1005.17); see file 09 and use the "I never opted in" branch below. To *prevent* future debit/ATM overdraft fees entirely, opt out (file 09).

PHONE SCRIPT

[OPEN]

"Hi, my name is [YOUR NAME]. I've banked with [BANK] for [X] years. I noticed an overdraft fee of [\$ AMOUNT] on my account from [DATE], and I'm hoping you can help me."

[THE ASK]

"I take responsibility for the overdraft, and I've already [brought the balance positive / made the deposit]. Would you be willing to reverse the fee as a one-time courtesy?"

→ **Then stop talking. Let them respond.**

► If they say YES

"Thank you, I really appreciate that. Can I get a reference number for the reversal, and when will the credit post to my account?" - Log it (file 10): date, rep name, reference #, amount, expected post date.

► If they say NO / "I'm not able to do that"

"I understand it's at your discretion. Is there a supervisor or a customer-loyalty team who might be able to make a one-time exception? I've been a customer since [YEAR] and I'd like to keep my account in good standing."

→ **If still NO:**

"Okay, I appreciate you checking. Two quick things: can you note that I asked for a courtesy reversal, and can you tell me how to make sure this doesn't happen again — for example, opting out of overdraft coverage or setting up a low-balance alert?" - Then try **chat** tomorrow with a different rep, or call back another day. A fresh rep is a fresh decision.

► If it was a DEBIT-CARD or ATM overdraft and you never opted in

"Before we go further — this fee was on a [debit-card purchase / ATM withdrawal]. I don't believe I ever opted in to overdraft coverage for everyday debit and ATM transactions. Under Regulation E, my understanding is the bank can

only charge those overdraft fees if I affirmatively opted in. Can you check whether I'm opted in, and if I'm not, refund this fee and confirm I'm opted out going forward?"

→ **If they confirm you weren't opted in:** this is a correction, not a courtesy — they should refund it. Get a reference number and confirm your opt-out status (file 09).

► **If they offer a partial reversal**

"I appreciate that. Could you do the full amount this once? If not, I'll take the partial and I appreciate the help."

LIVE-CHAT SCRIPT

You: Hi — I've been a [BANK] customer for [X] years. I was charged a [\$ AMOUNT] overdraft fee on [DATE]. I've already brought my balance positive. Would you be willing to reverse the fee as a one-time courtesy?

→ **If YES:**

You: Thank you so much. Could you send me a reference number and let me know when the credit will post? I'd like to save this chat transcript for my records.

→ **If NO:**

You: I understand it's discretionary. Is there a supervisor or loyalty team who can review a one-time exception? I've been with [BANK] since [YEAR] and would like to keep my account in good standing.

→ **If still NO:**

You: Understood, thank you for checking. Can you note that I requested a courtesy reversal on [DATE]? And can you tell me how to opt out of overdraft coverage so this can't happen again?

→ **Debit/ATM, never opted in:**

You: This fee was on a debit-card/ATM transaction. I don't believe I opted in to overdraft coverage for everyday debit and ATM transactions. Under Regulation E (12 CFR 1005.17), overdraft fees on those require my affirmative opt-in. Can you verify my opt-in status, and if I'm not opted in, refund this fee?

After the call/chat

- Save the chat transcript or write down the reference number immediately.
- Add the result to your **Reversal Log** (file 10).
- If a promised credit hasn't posted in the stated time, call back with the reference number — that's not a new ask, it's a follow-up.
- Want to stop this for good? Opt out of debit/ATM overdraft coverage (file 09).

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Late-Payment Fee Waiver — Phone + Chat Scripts

When/how to use this: Use right after a **late fee** posts on a credit card or loan — ideally before the next statement closes, and ideally when you've already paid (or are paying that minute). Strongest if you have a history of on-time payments. Have the card/loan open, the fee amount, and the payment date ready.

What law backs it: No law forces a waiver — it's a goodwill courtesy, and issuers grant it routinely for otherwise-good customers. Context: there is **no \$8 federal cap** on credit-card late fees — the 2024 CFPB rule was vacated in court on April 15, 2025 (N.D. Tex.). Late fees follow the older CARD Act "safe harbor" framework (roughly up to ~\$30 for a first late payment and ~\$41 for a repeat, inflation-adjusted) and whatever your cardholder agreement sets. Don't cite an \$8 cap; it isn't the law. One real lever you *do* have: if this is your **first** late payment in a long time, the CARD Act limits how high a *first-violation* fee can be — but your play here is courtesy, not statute.

PHONE SCRIPT

[OPEN]

"Hi, this is [YOUR NAME], account ending [LAST 4]. I've had this card for [X] years and I've paid on time consistently. I had a late fee of [\$ AMOUNT] post on [DATE]."

[THE ASK]

"I've already made the payment in full. Given my history, would you be willing to waive the late fee as a one-time courtesy?"

→ **Stop talking. Let them respond.**

► If they say YES

"Thank you, I appreciate it. Can I get a reference number, and will this also reverse any interest charged on the late amount? When will the credit post?" - Log it (file 10).

► If they say NO

"I understand it's discretionary. Is there a supervisor who can consider a one-time exception based on my payment history? I've been a cardholder since [YEAR] and this is the first time in a long while I've been late."

→ **If still NO:**

"I appreciate you looking. Could you at least note my request and my on-time history on the account? And can you set up an autopay or due-date reminder so this doesn't recur?" - Try chat another day with a different rep.

► If they waive the fee but NOT the interest

"Thanks for the fee. Could you also reverse the [\$ AMOUNT] interest tied to the late payment, since I've now paid in full? If not, I understand."

► If they say "you've already had a waiver this year"

"Understood — I didn't realize. I'll keep it on-time going forward. Can you tell me my exact due date and set up autopay so this can't happen again?" - Be honest with yourself: if you've used your courtesy, accept it and set up autopay.

LIVE-CHAT SCRIPT

You: Hi — I'm a [X]-year cardholder, account ending [LAST 4], with a strong on-time history. A [\$ AMOUNT] late fee posted on [DATE] and I've already paid in full. Given my history, would you be willing to waive the late fee as a one-time courtesy?

→ **If YES:**

You: Thank you. Could you also reverse any interest on the late balance, and send me a reference number plus the post date? I'll save this transcript.

→ **If NO:**

You: I understand it's discretionary. Could a supervisor consider a one-time exception based on my payment history since [YEAR]?

→ **If still NO:**

You: Understood — thank you for checking. Please note my request on the account. Can you also help me set up autopay so I never miss a due date again?

After the call/chat

- Confirm both the **fee** and any **interest** were reversed.
- Set up **autopay for at least the minimum** — it's the single best prevention.
- Log the result (file 10), including whether you've now used your annual courtesy.

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Monthly Maintenance Fee Waiver — Phone + Chat Scripts

When/how to use this: Use when a **monthly service / maintenance fee** posts on a checking or savings account. Your goal is two things at once: (1) reverse the fee that just hit, and (2) get the fee **permanently waived** going forward by meeting a waiver condition (direct deposit, minimum balance, or switching to a free account). Have your account and the fee amount/date ready.

What law backs it: No law forces this — it's a goodwill courtesy. The real leverage is that almost every bank already offers a **fee-waiver path** (e.g., a monthly direct deposit, a minimum balance, or a no-fee account tier) and a **genuinely free checking option** usually exists. You're asking them to apply what already exists. If you bank somewhere with no free option, this is also your cue to consider a no-fee online bank or credit union.

PHONE SCRIPT

[OPEN]

"Hi, this is [YOUR NAME]. I noticed a monthly maintenance fee of [\$ AMOUNT] on my [checking/savings] account on [DATE]. I'd like to sort this out two ways if I can."

[THE ASK — REVERSAL]

"First, would you be willing to reverse this month's fee as a one-time courtesy?"

[THE ASK — PREVENTION]

"And second, what do I need to do to have this fee waived every month — a direct deposit, a minimum balance, or switching to an account with no monthly fee?"

→ **Let them answer both.**

► If they say YES to the reversal

"Thank you. Can I get a reference number and the post date?" - Then move straight to prevention (below) so this is the last time.

► If they say NO to the reversal

"I understand. Is there a supervisor who could make a one-time exception? I've been a customer since [YEAR]."

→ **If still NO:** go to prevention anyway — getting the fee waived forever matters more than this one month.

► PREVENTION — pick the path they offer

- **Direct deposit:** "If I set up a direct deposit of [\$ AMOUNT], will that waive the fee every month? Can you set that requirement now?"
- **Minimum balance:** "What balance do I need to keep to avoid the fee? Can you note the exact threshold?"

- **Switch accounts:** "Do you have a checking account with no monthly maintenance fee that I qualify for? Can you switch me today, and will my account number and direct deposits carry over?"

► **If they have NO free option and won't waive**

"Understood. I appreciate your time. I may look at an account that better fits how I bank — can you confirm there's no early-closure fee and how to move my direct deposits if I do?"

LIVE-CHAT SCRIPT

You: Hi — a [\$ AMOUNT] monthly maintenance fee posted on my [checking/savings] on [DATE]. Two requests: (1) would you reverse this month's fee as a one-time courtesy, and (2) what do I need to do — direct deposit, minimum balance, or a no-fee account — to have it waived every month going forward?

→ **If YES to reversal:**

You: Thank you. Reference number and post date, please? And let's set up the waiver condition now so it doesn't recur.

→ **If NO to reversal:**

You: I understand. Could a supervisor review a one-time exception? Either way, please help me set up the monthly waiver so this is the last time.

→ **Prevention:**

You: Which is easiest to qualify for — the direct-deposit waiver, the minimum-balance waiver, or switching to a no-monthly-fee account? Please set up whichever I qualify for and confirm it's active.

After the call/chat

- Confirm the **waiver condition is active**, not just promised — ask them to read back the requirement and confirm it's on the account.
- If you switched accounts, verify the new account has **no monthly fee** and your direct deposits/auto-payments moved.
- Log it (file 10). Note the exact waiver requirement so you can keep meeting it.

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Returned-Item Fee Reversal — Phone + Chat Scripts

When/how to use this: Use when a **deposited item bounced** and your bank charged you a "returned deposited item" / "returned item" fee — for example, you deposited a check or accepted an ACH that was later returned unpaid, and the bank dinged *you* (the receiver) for it. This is distinct from an NSF fee on a payment *you* sent (use file 02 for that). Have the item, the return date, and the fee amount ready.

What law backs it: No law forces this reversal — it's a goodwill courtesy. The fair-minded angle that helps here: the item bounced because of the **payer**, not you, so you're asking the bank not to penalize you for someone else's bad check. Many banks will reverse a returned-deposited-item fee the first time, especially if you're chasing the payer to make it right. (Note: if the *amount* of the fee is wrong or it was charged in error, that's a dispute, not a courtesy — see the error branch.)

PHONE SCRIPT

[OPEN]

"Hi, this is [YOUR NAME]. I deposited a [check/ACH] on [DEPOSIT DATE] for [\$ ITEM AMOUNT], and it was returned unpaid. I see your returned-item fee of [\$ FEE AMOUNT] posted on [DATE]."

[THE ASK]

"The item bounced because of the person who paid me, not because of anything on my end — and I'm already working to collect from them. Would you be willing to reverse the returned-item fee as a one-time courtesy?"

→ **Stop talking.**

► If they say YES

"Thank you. Can I get a reference number and the post date for the credit?" - Log it (file 10).

► If they say NO

"I understand it's discretionary. Is there a supervisor who could make a one-time exception? I'm the one who got stiffed on the payment, so the fee feels like a double hit. I've banked here since [YEAR]."

→ **If still NO:**

"I appreciate you checking. Can you note my request, and tell me whether re-depositing the item would trigger another fee if it bounces again?" - Try chat another day with a different rep.

► If the fee amount looks WRONG or you were charged twice

"Before we treat this as a courtesy — I want to confirm this fee is even correct. I was charged [\$ FEE AMOUNT] on [DATE], but [I only deposited one item / I see two fees / this doesn't match my agreement]. Can you review whether this fee was applied in error? If it was, I'd like it corrected." - A genuine error is a correction, not a favor. Get a reference number.

► If they reversed the bank's fee but you're still out the bounced money

"Thanks for the fee reversal. Separately — what are my options to recover the [\$ ITEM AMOUNT] that bounced? Can I re-deposit, and is there anything you can flag on the payer's item?" - (Recovering the underlying money is between you and the payer; the bank can only handle its own fee.)

LIVE-CHAT SCRIPT

You: Hi — I deposited a [check/ACH] for [\$ ITEM AMOUNT] on [DEPOSIT DATE] and it was returned unpaid. A returned-item fee of [\$ FEE AMOUNT] posted on [DATE]. The item bounced on the payer's end, not mine, and I'm chasing them for it. Would you be willing to reverse the returned-item fee as a one-time courtesy?

→ **If YES:**

You: Thank you. Reference number and post date, please? I'll save this transcript.

→ **If NO:**

You: I understand it's discretionary. Could a supervisor review a one-time exception, given that the item bounced through no fault of mine? I've banked here since [YEAR].

→ **Wrong amount / charged twice:**

You: Can you first confirm this fee is correct? I see [describe discrepancy], which doesn't match my account agreement. If it was applied in error, please correct it rather than treat it as a courtesy.

After the call/chat

- Confirm the credit and **log it** (file 10).
- If you re-deposit the item, ask whether a second bounce triggers another fee.
- Remember: the bank can reverse **its fee**; getting your bounced **money** back is a matter between you and whoever wrote the bad check.

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ATM Fee Reversal — Phone + Chat Scripts

When/how to use this: Use when you were charged an **ATM fee** — either your own bank's out-of-network fee, the ATM operator's surcharge, or both — on a recent withdrawal. Best within a few days. Note that two separate fees can appear: one from **your bank** (out-of-network) and one from the **ATM owner** (surcharge). Your bank can reliably reverse its own fee; the surcharge it sometimes refunds as a courtesy or rebate.

What law backs it: No law forces this — it's a goodwill courtesy. Useful leverage: many accounts include a number of **free out-of-network ATM uses per month** or an **ATM-fee rebate** benefit you may not know you have, and some banks will refund a surcharge as a one-time courtesy. Ask what your account already includes. (If you see a surcharge you were never warned about at the machine, mention it — operators are generally required to disclose the surcharge before you complete the withdrawal.)

PHONE SCRIPT

[OPEN]

"Hi, this is [YOUR NAME]. I used an out-of-network ATM on [DATE] and I see [an out-of-network fee of \$ AMOUNT / a surcharge of \$ AMOUNT / both, totaling \$ AMOUNT]. I'm hoping you can help."

[THE ASK]

"Would you be willing to reverse the ATM fee as a one-time courtesy? And does my account include any free out-of-network ATM uses or ATM-fee rebates I should be using?"

→ **Let them answer both.**

► If they say YES

"Thank you. Does that cover both the out-of-network fee and the operator surcharge, or just one? Can I get a reference number and the post date?" - Log it (file 10).

► If they say NO

"I understand. Is there a supervisor who could do a one-time courtesy? I've been a customer since [YEAR]."

→ **If still NO:**

"Okay, I appreciate it. Can you tell me which ATMs are in-network and free for me, and whether my account has any out-of-network rebate I should switch on?"

► If they reverse THEIR fee but not the operator surcharge

"Thanks for reversing the out-of-network fee. The ATM operator also charged a [\$ AMOUNT] surcharge — is there any rebate or one-time courtesy you can apply to that as well? If not, I understand."

► If your account HAS a rebate/free-ATM benefit you didn't use

"It sounds like my account includes [rebates / free uses] I wasn't getting credit for. Can you apply that retroactively to this withdrawal, and make sure it's active going forward?"

LIVE-CHAT SCRIPT

You: Hi — I was charged an ATM fee on [DATE]: [\$ AMOUNT out-of-network / \$ AMOUNT surcharge / both]. Would you be willing to reverse it as a one-time courtesy? Also, does my account include any free out-of-network ATM uses or fee rebates?

→ **If YES:**

You: Thank you. Does that cover both the out-of-network fee and the operator surcharge? Reference number and post date, please.

→ **If NO:**

You: I understand it's discretionary. Could a supervisor apply a one-time courtesy? I've been a customer since [YEAR]. Either way — which ATMs are free for me, and do I have any rebate I should turn on?

After the call/chat

- Note whether they reversed **one fee or both** (out-of-network + surcharge).
- **Prevention:** ask for your in-network ATM map, or confirm any fee-rebate benefit is switched on. Going forward, use in-network ATMs or take cash back at a store register to avoid the fee entirely.
- Log it (file 10).

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Foreign-Transaction Fee Reversal — Phone + Chat Scripts

When/how to use this: Use when a **foreign-transaction fee** (typically 1%–3% of the purchase) posts on a credit or debit card — either from travel abroad or from an online purchase billed by a foreign merchant. Be realistic: FX fees are the **hardest** of all these to reverse, because they're a flat percentage the issuer/network actually incurs, not a penalty. Your stronger play is usually prevention (a no-FX-fee card). But a polite one-time ask still works often enough to be worth 5 minutes, especially for a first-time or surprise charge.

What law backs it: No law forces this — it's a goodwill courtesy, and a relatively grudging one. Honest framing: foreign-transaction fees are disclosed in your cardholder agreement and aren't penalties, so you're genuinely asking for a favor here. The realistic win is often a **one-time courtesy credit** plus a switch to a **no-foreign-transaction-fee card** so it never happens again.

PHONE SCRIPT

[OPEN]

"Hi, this is [YOUR NAME], account ending [LAST 4]. I see a foreign-transaction fee of [\$ AMOUNT] on a purchase from [DATE]. I wasn't expecting it, and I'm hoping you can help."

[THE ASK]

"I understand foreign-transaction fees are part of the card. As a [X]-year customer, would you be willing to refund this one as a one-time courtesy? And does the bank offer a card with no foreign-transaction fee I could switch to?"

→ **Let them answer both.**

► If they say YES

"Thank you, I really appreciate that. Can I get a reference number and the post date?" - Log it (file 10), then ask about the no-FX-fee card so it doesn't recur.

► If they say NO (most common)

"I completely understand — I know it's not a penalty fee. Is there any one-time courtesy credit you can apply given my history? And which of your cards has no foreign-transaction fee?"

→ **If still NO:**

"No problem, thanks for checking. I do a fair amount of [travel / international shopping], so a no-foreign-transaction-fee card would suit me better. Can you tell me which card that is and how to switch without opening a new account, if possible?"

► If the charge looks WRONG (you didn't buy abroad, or it's a duplicate)

"Actually, I want to confirm this is even a valid foreign-transaction fee. This purchase was [from a U.S. merchant / one I don't recognize / charged twice]. Can you review whether this was applied in error? If I don't recognize the underlying

charge at all, I'd like to dispute the transaction." - A misapplied FX fee or an unrecognized charge is a **dispute**, not a courtesy. For an unauthorized charge, your card's dispute process (and, for debit, Reg E error resolution) applies — see file 09's note on disputes.

LIVE-CHAT SCRIPT

You: Hi — a foreign-transaction fee of [\$ AMOUNT] posted on a purchase from [DATE], account ending [LAST 4]. I understand it's part of the card, but as a [X]-year customer, would you refund this one as a one-time courtesy? And do you offer a card with no foreign-transaction fee?

→ **If YES:**

You: Thank you. Reference number and post date, please. I'll save this transcript.

→ **If NO:**

You: Understood — I know it isn't a penalty. Any one-time courtesy credit given my history? And which of your cards has no foreign-transaction fee, so this doesn't recur?

→ **Looks wrong / unrecognized:**

You: Can you confirm this fee is valid? The purchase was [U.S. merchant / unrecognized / duplicated]. If the underlying charge isn't mine, I'd like to dispute it, not treat it as a courtesy.

After the call/chat

- If refunded, confirm the **reference number** and post date; log it (file 10).
- **Prevention is the real win:** for any regular international spending, get a **no-foreign-transaction-fee card**. The fee you avoid forever beats the one you claw back once.
- For debit abroad, check whether your bank refunds or waives FX fees on certain accounts before your next trip.

Money You're Owed — the official process is always free.

Credit-Card Annual Fee — Retention + Product-Change Call

When/how to use this: Use when your **annual fee** just posted (or is about to) and you want one of three outcomes, in order of preference: (1) **fee waived** or offset by a retention offer; (2) **product change / downgrade** to a no-annual-fee version of the same card (keeps your account age and credit line); or (3) a clear decision to keep, downgrade, or cancel. Call in the **statement cycle the fee posts** — most issuers will reverse a freshly posted annual fee if you act fast. Have the card, the fee amount, and your usage in mind.

What law backs it: No law forces a waiver or retention offer — these are pure business/goodwill decisions, and issuers make them constantly to keep customers. Useful, honest context: a **product change** (e.g., downgrading to the no-fee version of the same card) is usually treated as keeping the **same account**, so it typically does **not** start a new account or close the old one — better for your credit history than canceling. Confirm this with the rep for your specific card.

PHONE SCRIPT — ask for "retention" or "cancellations"

Tip: When the menu asks, say "**cancel**" or "**close my account**." That routes you to the retention/loyalty team — the people who can actually waive fees and make offers.

[OPEN]

"Hi, this is [YOUR NAME], account ending [LAST 4]. My [\$ AMOUNT] annual fee just posted on [DATE], and I'm deciding whether the card still makes sense for me. I've been a cardholder for [X] years."

[THE ASK]

"Before I make any changes, is there a retention offer available — a fee waiver, a statement credit, or bonus points that would offset the annual fee?"

→ **Let them check. Stay quiet while they look.**

► If they OFFER a waiver or retention offer

"That works — let's do that. Can you confirm the offer in writing or give me a reference number, and tell me exactly when the credit posts and any spending requirement?" - Log it (file 10): the offer, the reference #, any "spend \$X" condition and deadline.

► If they offer NOTHING (or a weak offer)

"I appreciate you checking. If there's no offer that offsets the fee, can you tell me whether there's a **no-annual-fee version of this card** I could switch to with a product change — keeping my same account, history, and credit line?"

► PRODUCT CHANGE / DOWNGRADE branch

"I'd like to do a product change to the no-annual-fee [CARD NAME] rather than cancel. Can you confirm: does this keep my same account number and account age, does it refund or remove the annual fee, and does it avoid a hard credit pull?"

→ **If they confirm:** great — that keeps your credit history intact and kills the fee. → **If a product change isn't available:** decide between paying the fee (if the rewards justify it) or canceling (below).

► **CANCEL branch — only if you mean it and the math says so**

"Understood. If there's no offer and no fee-free product change, I'd like to cancel before the fee becomes non-refundable. Can you confirm the annual fee will be refunded on closure, and that there's no balance or pending rewards I'd forfeit?" - Before canceling, weigh: closing a card can lower your average account age and total available credit, which can affect your credit score. Downgrading (product change) usually avoids that. Don't cancel just to make a point.

LIVE-CHAT SCRIPT

You: Hi — my [\$ AMOUNT] annual fee posted on [DATE], account ending [LAST 4]. I'm a [X]-year cardholder deciding whether to keep the card. Before I change anything: is there a retention offer — a fee waiver, statement credit, or bonus points — that would offset the annual fee?

→ **If offer:**

You: That works. Please confirm the offer and any spending requirement in writing, with a reference number and the credit post date.

→ **If no offer:**

You: Understood. Is there a no-annual-fee version of this card I can switch to via a product change — keeping the same account, history, and credit line, with no hard pull? If so, I'd like to do that and have the annual fee removed.

→ **Product change confirm:**

You: To confirm: product change keeps my account number and age, removes/refunds the annual fee, and avoids a hard inquiry — correct? Please process it and send confirmation.

After the call/chat

- If you got a **retention offer**, write down any **spending requirement and deadline** — offers often require "spend \$X in Y months." Missing it means no credit. Log it (file 10).
- If you did a **product change**, confirm the new card has **no annual fee** and your account history carried over.
- Decision rule: **waiver > product change/downgrade > pay the fee (if rewards justify) > cancel**. Cancel last — it can ding your credit.

Money You're Owed — the official process is always free.

Regulation E Overdraft Opt-OUT Request — Phone + Chat + Written

When/how to use this: Use this when you want to **stop future overdraft fees on your everyday debit-card and ATM transactions** for good. This is the one asset in the pack that asserts an actual **right**, not a courtesy. By opting out (or confirming you never opted in), your bank must **decline** an ATM or one-time debit-card transaction that would overdraw your account instead of paying it and charging you a fee. Do this once and you remove a whole category of future fees.

Read the limit carefully — this is important: Opting out under Regulation E only stops overdraft fees on **ATM withdrawals and one-time (everyday) debit-card purchases**. It does **NOT** stop overdraft fees on: - **Checks** you write, - **ACH / automatic bill payments** (e.g., your electric bill, gym, subscriptions), - **Recurring debit-card payments** (e.g., a monthly streaming charge set up on your card).

Those are governed by your account agreement, not by this rule. So opting out is powerful but not total — pair it with low-balance alerts (covered at the end).

What law backs it: Regulation E, 12 CFR 1005.17. A bank may **not** charge you an overdraft fee on an ATM or one-time debit-card transaction **unless you affirmatively opted in** to that "overdraft service" after getting the required notice. You have the right to **opt out / revoke that consent at any time**, and the bank must honor it. There are **no required "magic words"** — you just have to make your choice clear and have it documented. *(Verified 2026: 12 CFR 1005.17 remains in force. Note the 2024 CFPB large-bank overdraft rule was nullified by Congress on May 9, 2025 (S.J. Res. 18 / Pub. L. 119-10) and is NOT law — but that has no effect on this opt-out right, which predates it and is unchanged.)*

Two things to ask for at once: (1) opt me OUT going forward, and (2) if I was charged ATM/one-time-debit overdraft fees while *not* opted in, refund them — that's a correction, not a courtesy.

PHONE SCRIPT

[OPEN]

"Hi, this is [YOUR NAME], account ending [LAST 4]. I want to opt out of overdraft coverage for my ATM and everyday debit-card transactions, and confirm my current status."

[THE REQUEST]

"Under Regulation E, my bank can only charge overdraft fees on ATM and one-time debit-card transactions if I've opted in. I want to make sure I am opted **out** — meaning if a debit-card purchase or ATM withdrawal would overdraw my account, please decline it rather than pay it and charge me an overdraft fee. Can you set that and confirm it's active?"

→ **Let them process it.**

► **Confirm it took**

"Thank you. Can you confirm in writing — or give me a reference number — that I'm now opted out of overdraft coverage for ATM and one-time debit transactions, effective today? And to be clear: going forward those transactions will simply be declined if I don't have the funds, with no overdraft fee — correct?"

► If you were charged ATM/debit overdraft fees while NOT opted in (refund branch)

"I also want to check my history. I was charged overdraft fees on [DATE(S)] for [debit-card / ATM] transactions. Can you confirm whether I had actually opted in at those times? If I had not opted in, those fees shouldn't have been charged under Regulation E, and I'd like them refunded as a correction."

→ **If they confirm you weren't opted in:** this is not a favor — get each fee refunded and a reference number for each.

► If the rep is confused or pushes back

"To be specific, I'm referring to the Regulation E opt-in rule — 12 CFR 1005.17 — which says you can't charge overdraft fees on ATM or one-time debit transactions unless I opted in, and that I can revoke that consent at any time. I'm revoking it now. Can you process that or transfer me to someone who can?"

► Set expectations on the trade-off (so you're not surprised)

"I understand that with overdraft coverage off, an ATM withdrawal or debit purchase that exceeds my balance will be **declined** instead of going through with a fee. That's what I want. Can you confirm that's how it will behave?"

LIVE-CHAT SCRIPT

You: Hi — account ending [LAST 4]. I want to opt OUT of overdraft coverage for ATM and one-time debit-card transactions under Regulation E (12 CFR 1005.17). Going forward, if a debit purchase or ATM withdrawal would overdraw my account, please decline it rather than charge an overdraft fee. Can you set that and confirm it's active today?

→ **Confirm:**

You: Thank you. Please confirm in writing that I'm opted out for ATM and one-time debit transactions, effective today, and that those will be declined (no overdraft fee) if I lack the funds. I'll save this transcript.

→ **Refund branch (charged while not opted in):**

You: I was also charged [debit-card/ATM] overdraft fees on [DATE(S)]. Can you confirm whether I had opted in at those times? If I had not, those fees weren't permitted under Reg E and I'd like them refunded as a correction, with a reference number for each.

→ **If pushed back:**

You: To be precise, this is the Regulation E opt-in rule, 12 CFR 1005.17. You can't charge overdraft fees on ATM/one-time debit transactions unless I opted in, and I can revoke consent any time. I'm revoking it now. Please process it or route me to someone who can.

WRITTEN VERSION (secure message / mail — gives you a paper trail)

Subject: Opt-Out of Overdraft Service for ATM and One-Time Debit Transactions — [YOUR NAME], Acct ending [LAST 4]

To Whom It May Concern,

I am writing to revoke my consent ("opt out") to overdraft service for ATM and one-time (everyday) debit-card transactions on the account ending in [LAST 4], pursuant to Regulation E, 12 CFR 1005.17.

Effective immediately, please do **not** authorize and pay ATM or one-time debit-card transactions that would overdraw my account. I understand and prefer that such transactions be **declined** rather than paid with an overdraft fee.

If your records show I was previously charged overdraft fees on ATM or one-time debit-card transactions during any period in which I had **not** affirmatively opted in, please treat those charges as improperly assessed under 12 CFR 1005.17 and refund them. Please confirm in writing that this opt-out is active, the effective date, and the disposition of any such refunds.

Thank you, [YOUR NAME] [DATE] [PHONE / EMAIL]

After you opt out — close the remaining gaps

Opting out kills ATM/debit overdraft fees, but **checks, ACH, and recurring debits can still overdraw and trigger fees**. To cover those:

1. **Turn on low-balance alerts** (text/email) so you know before a bill hits.
2. **Link a savings account or set up "overdraft protection transfer"** — a transfer from savings to cover a shortfall.
Ask whether your bank charges a transfer fee (many no longer do); a small transfer fee is usually far cheaper than a \$35 overdraft fee, and some banks have eliminated it entirely.
3. **Confirm your opt-out is recorded** — ask the rep to read it back and log the reference number (file 10).

Money You're Owed — the official process is always free. This opt-out is your right under federal law; you never pay anyone to exercise it.

Reversal Log — Track Every Request

When/how to use this: Fill in one row every time you ask for a fee reversal — by phone, chat, or in writing. It does three jobs: (1) it gives you the **reference number and promised post date** so you can follow up if a credit never lands; (2) it tells you **whether you've already used your "courtesy" for the year** at a given bank, so you don't burn it twice; and (3) it builds a record you can hand to the CFPB if a bank is unreasonable. Use the Markdown table below, or import `reversal-log.csv` into Google Sheets / Excel for sorting and totals.

What law backs it: Nothing — this is just good record-keeping. But it's the difference between "I think they said they'd refund it" and a reference number you can quote. If you ever escalate to a CFPB complaint (consumerfinance.gov/complaint — free), this log is exactly the documentation they ask for.

How to fill each column

- **Date asked** — when you made the request.
- **Bank / Issuer** — which institution.
- **Fee type** — overdraft, NSF, late, maintenance, returned-item, ATM, foreign-transaction, annual fee.
- **Fee amount** — the dollar amount you asked to reverse.
- **Channel** — phone, chat, or written.
- **Rep name / ID** — who you spoke to (ask for a name or agent ID).
- **Reference #** — the case/confirmation number. **Always ask for this.**
- **Outcome** — Reversed full / Reversed partial / Denied / Pending.
- **Amount credited** — what you actually got back.
- **Promised post date** — when they said the credit would land.
- **Posted? (Y/N)** — check back and mark it.
- **Notes / next step** — e.g., "used annual courtesy," "try chat next week," "set up autopay," "follow up if not posted by [date]."

Log table

Date asked	Bank / Issuer	Fee type	Fee amount	Channel	Rep name / ID	Reference #	Outcome	Amount credited	Promised post date	Posted? (Y/N)	Notes / next step

Worked example (so you can see what a filled row looks like)

Date asked	Bank / Issuer	Fee type	Fee amount	Channel	Rep name / ID	Reference #	Outcome	Amount credited	Promised post date	Posted? (Y/N)	Notes / next step
2026-06-10	Example Bank	Overdraft	\$35.00	Phone	Maria (ID 4471)	CR-99231	Reversed full	\$35.00	2026-06-12	Y	First courtesy this year — used. Set up

Date asked	Bank / Issuer	Fee type	Fee amount	Channel	Rep name / ID	Reference #	Outcome	Amount credited	Promised post date	Posted? (Y/N)	Notes / next step
											low-balance alert.
2026-06-10	Example Card	Late fee	\$30.00	Chat	(transcript saved)	LF-10882	Reversed full	\$30.00	2026-06-13	N	Follow up if not posted by 06/16. Autopay now on.

Follow-up rules

- **If a promised credit hasn't posted by the date given**, call back with the **reference number**. That's not a new ask — it's enforcing a commitment they already made. Reference the row in this log.
- **If you're denied twice on the same fee**, try the other channel (phone ↔ chat) with a fresh rep before giving up — a different person is a different decision.
- **If a bank charged you ATM/one-time-debit overdraft fees while you weren't opted in** (file 09), that's a correction, not a courtesy — push for the refund and note it here as "Reg E correction."
- **If a bank is genuinely unreasonable about a fee that was its own error**, your free escalation is a **CFPB complaint** at consumerfinance.gov/complaint. Attach this log.

Money You're Owed — the official process is always free. This log just makes sure you actually collect what they promised.

Reversal Log (importable spreadsheet)

This table is also provided as an editable .csv you can import into Google Sheets, Excel, or Notion.

[illegible]